

play audio quite easily through the console.

The one place where the PSP falters is storage space. While Sony has made provisions to support Memory Stick Micro cards of up to 16 GB in size, the cards themselves remain quite expensive. Additionally, most modern PMPs (personal media players) like the iPod offer more storage space for users with vast audio and video collections.

Still, when compared to the DSi, which offers nothing more than a substandard audio player, the PlayStation Portable is the definite winner in this round.

3.5.2 FOR GAMING

Serious Gaming

In a way, the PlayStation Portable brought serious gaming to the handheld genre, so it was always going to be the weapon of choice here.

From the layout of the controls to the hardware it packed, the PSP was always intended to be something that a gamer can carry around with him for intense gameplay, and not just play around with a plumber who likes to jump on turtles and run through pipes.

Some of the popular titles for the PSP, such as God of War: Chains of Olympus and Burnout Revenge, have taken the graphics and gameplay of handheld gaming to a whole new level. Our prediction is that the DS will never be able to catch up to this.

Social Gaming

As with the Wii being superior in all things 'fun', the DS easily outclasses the PSP for lighter gaming. If you are looking for quick and easy games to play while travelling, which require very little concentration and just let you have a good time, put your money on the Nintendo DS.

Apart from the innovative touchscreen offering a cool twist on the normal style of gameplay, it also makes the features that surround gaming a lot more fun.

While social interaction during multiplayer gaming is available on both the PSP and the DS, the experience on the latter is a lot cooler than that on Sony's gadget.

It should be noted that if you are going to buy a Nintendo DS in India, the chances are high that you might have to shell out a lot more than on the PlayStation Portable.

Sony has officially launched the PSP in India and continually updates its line as new iterations of the console come out.

Nintendo, on the other hand, has never officially released its product in India and is mostly available through third-party dealers and the grey market.

So if something goes wrong with your PSP, you are fully covered by the